

安徽大学 2025—2026 学年第 二 学期

《大学英语 (A) II》期中考试试卷

(闭卷 时间 120 分钟)

考场登记表序号 _____

题 号	I	II	III	IV	总分
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阅卷人					

Part I Listening Comprehension (30 points, 1 point each)

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Section A

Directions: *In this section, you will hear 4 conversations. The questions for each conversation have been given already. After you hear the conversations, you must choose the best answer from the four choices marked [A], [B], [C] and [D]. Then mark the corresponding letter on the Answer Sheet with a single line through the centre.*

Conversation One

Questions 1 and 2 are based on the conversation you have just heard.

1. What is the man's opinion on stress in his job?
[A] He feels stress is the worst part of his job.
[B] He sees stress as a sign of poor performance.
[C] He thinks stress can be positive if managed correctly.
[D] He believes stress should be avoided completely at all costs.
2. What can be inferred about the man's approach to relaxation?
[A] He prefers watching TV at home.
[B] He avoids any activity related to work.
[C] He avoids physical activities after a stressful day.
[D] He relies on takeaway meals for convenience and taste.

Conversation Two

Questions 3 to 5 are based on the conversation you have just heard.

3. Why did Candy Chang start the "Before I Die" project?
- [A] She was feeling unhappy.
 - [B] She knew the project would be popular.
 - [C] She wanted to make her neighbourhood attractive.
 - [D] She hoped to collect funny responses from strangers.
4. According to the conversation, what happened after Chang's wall became popular?
- [A] People started to ignore it.
 - [B] The government removed it.
 - [C] Only silly responses were added.
 - [D] Other people began to create similar walls.
5. What pattern did Ana notice in the responses?
- [A] People mainly wrote about their career goals.
 - [B] Most people wanted to travel to foreign countries.
 - [C] The responses focused mainly on material possessions and silly hopes.
 - [D] Many responses expressed a desire to help others and improve the world.

Conversation Three

Questions 6 and 7 are based on the conversation you have just heard.

6. What form is the woman filling out?
- [A] A financial aid application form.
 - [B] A course registration form.
 - [C] A graduation form for the Dean's office.
 - [D] An internship application form.
7. What does the man suggest about the curriculum changes?
- [A] They will delay the graduation of all students.
 - [B] They apply to all students regardless of their year.
 - [C] They require everyone to take International Banking I.
 - [D] They only apply to first-year and second-year students.

Conversation Four

Questions 8 to 10 are based on the conversation you have just heard.

8. What is the main topic of the conversation?
- [A] How to think divergently and critically.

- [B] The difference between chance and luck.
 - [C] The invention of microwave oven by Spencer.
 - [D] The concept of serendipity and how it works.
9. According to the conversation, what did Percy Spencer notice that led to the invention of the microwave oven?
- [A] A chocolate bar melting in his pocket.
 - [B] Microwaves could cook food quickly.
 - [C] His shirt was dirty because of the chocolate.
 - [D] The government project was completely a failure.
10. What is divergent thinking as explained in the conversation?
- [A] Noticing things that are annoying.
 - [B] Solving problems by following a strict plan.
 - [C] Thinking of many different uses for an object.
 - [D] Focusing on one goal and ignoring distractions.

Section B

Directions: *In this section, you will hear 4 short passages. The questions for each passage have been given already. After you hear the passages, you must choose the best answer from the four choices marked [A], [B], [C] and [D]. Then mark the corresponding letter on the Answer Sheet with a single line through the centre.*

Passage One

Questions 11 to 14 are based on the passage you have just heard.

11. What is the main idea of the passage?
- [A] The speaker made a bucket list and one of her wishes was to become a ballerina.
 - [B] The speaker made a bucket list and her biggest dream was to travel.
 - [C] The speaker made a bucket list and had mixed feelings when achieving her dreams.
 - [D] The speaker made a bucket list and felt happy to realize most of her dreams.
12. What is the benefit of making a bucket list according to the speaker?
- [A] It will force you to think about life in terms of impending death.
 - [B] It will force you to achieve your dreams as early as possible.
 - [C] It will force you to think about death at an early age.

[D] It will force you to take a close look at your life.

13. How many of the speaker's dreams are listed in the passage?

[A] 8.

[B] 6.

[C] 5.

[D] 4.

14. Which of the following is **NOT** mentioned in the speaker's bucket list?

[A] Visiting Bran Castle.

[B] Scuba diving.

[C] Working as a ballerina.

[D] Starting a catering business.

Passage Two

Questions 15 to 20 are based on the passage you have just heard.

15. What is the primary cause of the rapid global warming in the last century?

[A] The climate changes.

[B] Changes in solar radiation.

[C] Increased volcanic activities.

[D] Human activities such as burning fossil fuels.

16. How is the greenhouse effect produced based on the passage?

[A] By the release of carbon dioxide and other gases into the atmosphere.

[B] By the increase in ocean temperatures which releases dissolved carbon dioxide.

[C] By the reflection of sunlight which leads to more heat absorption.

[D] By the melting Arctic Sea ice, exposing darker ocean water to more solar radiation.

17. What evidence does the passage provide for global warming?

[A] A rise in the number of hurricanes.

[B] The extinction of several species.

[C] A series of warm years and a decline in Arctic Sea ice.

[D] An increase in severe droughts in the past two decades.

18. How many degrees Celsius will the average temperature increase by the end of the century according to the researchers' prediction?

[A] 1 to 6 degrees.

[B] 10 degrees.

[C] 2 to 5 degrees.

[D] 11 degrees.

[C] Grounds from 95 million cups.

[D] Grounds from 1 million cups.

25. What is the main idea of the news report?

[A] A new way to make coffee.

[B] An innovative way to create biofuel.

[C] A new way to grow coffee plants.

[D] An innovative way to extract fuel from vegetables.

Passage Four

Questions 26 to 30 are based on the passage you have just heard.

26. What is the name of the new sensor technology developed by Elbit Systems?

[A] Canary.

[B] Falcon.

[C] Eagle.

[D] Hawk.

27. What may cause a pilot to become unconscious during flight?

[A] The plane is flying too fast.

[B] The pilots blood flows too slowly.

[C] The plane is accelerating too quickly.

[D] The pilot is accidentally injured by fighter jets.

28. What problem does the new system aim to address?

[A] Pilot fatigue and stress during long flight.

[B] Engine failure and mechanical malfunctions.

[C] Unconsciousness caused by acceleration and hypoxia.

[D] Communication errors between pilots and ground.

29. How does the new system work when the pilot becomes unconscious?

[A] It takes control of the plane and guides it to safety.

[B] It sends a warning signal directly to the pilot in a second.

[C] It alerts the ground control immediately.

[D] It activates an emergency oxygen supply system.

30. What is the news report mainly about?

[A] A new system to warn the miners of the impending disaster.

[B] A new sensor technology to keep pilots safe.

[C] A new sensor technology to detect disasters.

[D] A new system to assist pilots' flight.

Part II Reading Comprehension (30 points, 2 points each)

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Section A

Directions: *In this section, you are going to read a passage followed by five questions. For each of them there are four choices marked [A], [B], [C] and [D]. You should decide on the best choice and mark the corresponding letter on the Answer Sheet with a single line through the centre.*

Questions 31 to 35 are based on the following passage.

Sugar shocked. That describes the reaction of many Americans this week following revelations that, 50 years ago, the sugar industry paid Harvard scientists for research that shifted the focus away from sugar's role in heart disease — and put the spotlight squarely on dietary fat.

What might surprise consumers is just how many present-day nutrition studies are still funded by the food industry. Nutrition scholar Marion Nestle of New York University spent a year informally tracking industry-funded studies on food. "Roughly 90% of nearly 179 studies favored the sponsor's interest," Nestle tells us. Other systematic reviews support her conclusions.

For instance, studies funded by Welch Foods — the brand behind Welch's 100% Grape Juice — found that drinking Concord grape juice daily may boost brain function. Another, funded by Quaker Oats, concluded, as a *Daily Mail* story put it, that "hot oatmeal (燕麦粥) breakfast keeps you full for longer."

Last year, *The New York Times* revealed how Coca-Cola was funding well-known scientists and organizations promoting a message that, in the battle against weight gain, people should pay more attention to exercise and less to what they eat and drink. Coca-Cola also released data detailing its funding of several medical institutions and associations between 2010 and 2015.

"It's certainly a problem that so much research in nutrition and health is funded by industry," says Bonnie Liebman, director of nutrition at the Center for Science in the Public Interest. "When the food industry pays for research, it often gets what it pays for." And what it pays for is often a pro-industry finding.

Given this environment, consumers should be *skeptical* (怀疑的) when reading the

latest finding in nutrition science and ignore the latest study that pops up on your news feed. “Rely on health experts who’ve reviewed all the evidence,” Liebman says, pointing to the official government Dietary Guidelines, which are based on reviews of hundreds of studies.

“And that expert advice remains pretty simple,” says Nestle. “We know what healthy diets are — lots of vegetables, not too much junk food, balanced calories. Everything else is really difficult to do experimentally.”

(353 words)

31. What did Harvard scientists do 50 years ago?

- [A] They raised public awareness of the possible causes of heart disease.
- [B] They turned public attention away from the health risks of sugar to fat.
- [C] They placed the sugar industry in the spotlight with their new findings .
- [D] They conducted large-scale research on the role of sugar in people’s health.

32. What does Marion Nestle say about present-day nutrition studies?

- [A] They took her a full year to track and analyze.
- [B] Most of them are based on systematic reviews.
- [C] They depend on funding from the food industries.
- [D] Nearly all of them serve the purpose of the funders.

33. What did Coca-Cola-funded studies claim?

- [A] Exercise is more important to good health than diet.
- [B] Choosing what to eat and drink is key to weight control.
- [C] Drinking Coca-Cola does not contribute to weight gain.
- [D] The food industry plays a major role in fighting obesity.

34. What does Liebman say about industry-funded research?

- [A] It simply focuses on nutrition and health.
- [B] It causes confusion among consumers.
- [C] It rarely results in objective findings.
- [D] It runs counter to the public interest.

35. What is the author’s advice to consumers?

- [A] Follow their intuition in deciding what to eat.
- [B] Be doubtful of diet experts’ recommendations.
- [C] Ignore irrelevant information on their news feed.

[D] Think twice about new nutrition research findings.

Section B

Directions: *In this section, you are going to read a passage with ten statements attached to it. Each statement contains information given in one of the paragraphs. Identify the paragraph from which the information is derived. You may choose a paragraph more than once. Each paragraph is marked with a letter. Answer the questions by marking the corresponding letter on the Answer Sheet.*

Questions 36 to 45 are based on the following passage.

How to not be boring

- [A] Humans are creatures of habit. We love to establish a routine and stick with it. Then we often put ourselves on auto-pilot. Routines can be incredibly useful in helping you get things done. However, too much of a routine can also make you incredibly boring. Nevertheless, many people live lives that are boringly predictable, or live a life where everything is outlined or planned.
- [B] To tell the truth, interesting people are more popular among their friends. If you don't arouse someone's curiosity or brighten someone's day, you probably come across as being a little bit dull. But that doesn't mean your life has ended and you can't do anything to change it. If you find yourself searching for something to say beyond small talk, try these tactics to find more interesting approaches to conversation.
- [C] Recently, I was at a gathering of colleagues when someone turned to me and asked, "So, what's new with you?" Ordinarily, I think I'm a good conversationalist. After all, it's literally my job to talk to people and tell their stories or share their advice. And that's not exactly an unexpected question. Still, the only "new-to-me" topics that came to mind were my daughter's basketball tournament and my feelings about that morning's political headlines — neither amusing nor appropriate topics at the moment.
- [D] Oh, no, I thought. Have I become boring? But sharing our experiences in an authentic way to connect with other people is what makes us interesting, says associate professor Michael Pirson. The hesitation I felt in not sharing the ordinary things that were happening in my life, and the wild mental search for something more interesting, may have backfired and made me seem less interesting.
- [E] "If someone is making up some conversation that might be interesting, it's probably not going to land well," says Pirson, whose expertise includes trust and well-being, mindfulness, and humanistic management. "It's going to feel like a made-up conversation that people don't necessarily want to tune in to."

- [F] The most interesting people aren't those who've gone on some Eat, Pray, Love journey to find themselves. Instead, Pirson says, they're those who examine the ordinary. "Often, the 'boring things' may not be boring at all. Maybe they are actually little miracles," he says. Share your observations about the world around you — interesting stories you heard or things you noticed — and you may be surprised by the universal connection they inspire.
- [G] This is essentially how Jessica Hagy starts her day. The author of *How to Be Interesting: An Instruction Manual*, Hagy spends a lot of time thinking about what's interesting to her. People who are interesting are persistently curious, she says.
- [H] Think about the everyday things around you and ask questions about them. What is that roadside monument I see on my way to work every day? Who built that interesting building in my city? What nearby attractions haven't I visited? Why do people do things that way? Use what you find to ask more questions and learn more about the world around you. "Having that sort of curiosity is almost like a protective gear from getting into boredom," she says. And when you find things that are truly interesting to you, share them.
- [I] Television veteran Audrey Morrissey, executive producer of NBC's *The Voice*, is always looking for what will make a person or story interesting to viewers. It's usually a matter of individuality. "Having a strong point of view, signature style, or being a super-enthusiast in a particular field makes someone interesting," she says. That means embracing what is truly interesting or unique about yourself. "Many people are 'not boring' in the way that they can carry a conversation or can be good at a social gathering, etc. To be interesting means that you have lived life, taken risks, traveled, sought out experience to learn for yourself and share with others," she says.
- [J] Of course, it's possible to be a fountain of knowledge and a boring person, says public relations consultant Andrea Pass. Paying attention to the listener is an important part of having a conversation that's interesting to both parties. Talking on and on about what's interesting to you isn't going to make you an interesting person, she says.
- [K] "If the listener is not paying attention, it's your sign to shorten the story or change direction. Make sure to bring the audience into the conversation so that it is not one-sided," Pass says. Be a better listener yourself, and give others opportunities to participate in the conversation by inviting them with questions or requests to share their own experiences or thoughts. (e.g., "Now, tell me about your favourite book," or "Have you ever been to that attraction?") Questions are a powerful tool, especially when they encourage others to disclose information about themselves. A 2012 study from the University of California, Santa Barbara, found that roughly 40% of the time we are talking, we're disclosing subjective information about our experience. And when we're

doing so, our brains are more engaged. So one strategy to leave others with the impression that you're a sparkling conversation partner is to get others to talk about themselves.

[L] Being relatable is also essential, Morrissey says. "The best entertainment and storytelling comes from people who are relatable — those who don't shy away from opening up but freely share who they are and what they care about. These are the people viewers most relate to and find interesting. Being authentic, honest, and vulnerable is always interesting."

[M] I have now come to realize that being boring, in actuality, is not only about who you are as a person, but also how you present yourself. No matter what, make sure you are having fun in life. Because when you are enjoying, people around you will begin to enjoy as well. Show some interest in them and they will definitely show some in you. If you are a very reserved person, this could be a little difficult at first. But with a little effort, you can definitely improve.

(1023 words)

36. Pirson claims that some ordinary things may often prove to be miraculously interesting.
37. To make a conversation interesting, it is important that you pay attention to the listener rather than simply talk on and on about what's interesting to you.
38. A person who is unable to stimulate others' curiosity or make their life enjoyable may appear somewhat boring.
39. Interesting people usually possesses certain unique qualities, according to a TV program producer.
40. Be interested in others and they are sure to be interested in you.
41. The author considers himself usually good at conducting conversations.
42. Interesting people are always full of curiosity.
43. Falling into a routine can turn a person into an utter bore.
44. One strategy to be a good conversationalist is to motivate your partner to tell their own stories.
45. Interesting as it might appear, a made-up conversation will probably turn out to be dull.

Part III Vocabulary and Structure (25 points, 1 point each)

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Directions: *There are 25 incomplete sentences in this part. For each sentence there are four choices marked [A], [B], [C] and [D]. Choose the answer that best completes the sentence. Then mark the corresponding letter on the Answer Sheet with a single line*

through the centre.

46. There are estimates that as much as 70 percent of the meaning we _____ from a face-to-face encounter with someone comes from non-verbal cues: facial expressions, intonation, body language and pitch.
[A] arrive [B] derive [C] approve [D] remove
47. The Unicode Consortium continues to _____ applications for new emojis.
[A] process [B] proceed [C] progress [D] procedure
48. "Digital communication is here to stay," Evans said. "We are all virtually connected, and we're in the midst of a digital revolution. For it to be as successful as spoken language, it needs this kind of system to _____ and support messages coming from text."
[A] complicate [B] compensate [C] compliment [D] complement
49. One needs to _____ a request to register a new account to use WeChat.
[A] permit [B] admit [C] submit [D] commit
50. In face of the challenge of long distance, we are going to pool our efforts to fulfill the task by online _____.
[A] correlation [B] collaboration [C] appreciation [D] admiration
51. She's trying to make a _____ with her first album for 20 years.
[A] comeback [B] throwback [C] drawback [D] dropout
52. It is important to Mr. Andrews that the project reaches out to young kids today as it can highlight how _____ a skill face-to-face communication is. Their generation is perhaps the one most dependent on technology and least familiar with good old chatting.
[A] dependent [B] unconventional [C] crucial [D] startling
53. Mr. Andrews explained that the idea to run across the USA came along because we wanted to return to the most basic form of _____ paired with the most basic form of communication.
[A] transportation [B] transaction [C] transfusion [D] transmission

54. The Let's Talk project's use of social media to spread its message has caused many to _____ Mr. Andrews of hypocrisy.
[A] accuse [B] charge [C] bash [D] condemn
55. The idea of improving things by introducing new ideas has always _____ to me.
[A] drawn [B] charmed [C] appealed [D] attracted
56. I came up with my business idea when friends started applying for internships. Such was the competition for places _____ they were having to apply for many schemes, which meant employers must have been receiving may awful "copy-and paste" applications from people who weren't genuinely interested.
[A] which [B] that [C] when [D] while
57. Go to relevant activities and _____ your university hosts. They can be excellent networking opportunities or maybe just good opportunities to practice your networking skills.
[A] affairs [B] matters [C] incidents [D] events
58. Get involved in entrepreneurship societies, too. You never know, you might meet good _____ — perhaps even a future business partner.
[A] contacts [B] contracts [C] concepts [D] concerns
59. Seriously consider a business partner. Sharing the workload will help you get more done, probably quicker, too. It's great to have someone to _____ ideas off and it can prevent you from feeling isolated.
[A] pounce [B] bounce [C] denounce [D] renounce
60. I've seen young entrepreneurs who, as soon as they _____ investment, go out and buy such things as ping-pong tables and other trendy items.
[A] stable [B] unstable [C] secure [D] insecure
61. The interface of this new app is _____ and user-friendly.
[A] affective [B] emotive [C] instinctive [D] intuitive
62. I always knew I wanted to work for myself: I had to do it or I would have gone mad. It was an _____, deep sense of how I wanted to live my life, even before I really knew what career path I would take.

[A] overflowing [B] overflown [C] overwhelming [D] overwhelmed

63. Not everyone _____ to my impertinent nature and there were definitely bumps along the way where I challenged my bosses too much.

[A] enjoyed [B] cooled [C] fancied [D] warmed

64. Each time I felt like the underdog, it just powered me on even more and while every year brought another challenge and reason to throw _____, I never did.

[A] in a rut [B] in the towel
[C] from the ashes [D] all over the place

65. A few years ago, I would have never thought I was someone who was “leader material.” Those traits were suppressed by my _____ meekness.

[A] debilitate [B] debilitating [C] deliberate [D] deliberating

66. I _____ previous leaders at the clinic and learned from them how to handle the team and how to solve problems that came up.

[A] sheltered [B] shielded [C] shadowed [D] shaded

67. However, even after you campaign hard and try your hardest to be a leader, if it doesn't _____ there are other ways to stay strong in that activity.

[A] work out [B] watch out [C] go about [D] get over

68. I knew that colleges wanted leadership in one's activities, but that was a skill I was deficient in. What would I do? Introversion was my _____, while extroversion eluded me.

[A] drama [B] epitome [C] rapport [D] specialty

69. A combination of innovation and meticulous attention to detail has _____ to the luxury brand's success.

[A] attributed [B] contributed [C] distributed [D] instituted

70. Leaders should have trust in their team members and _____.

[A] delegate [B] allocate [C] relegate [D] alternate

Part IV Cloze (15 points, 1.5 points each)

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Directions: *In this section, there is a passage with ten blanks. You are required to select one word for each blank from a list of choices given in a word bank following the passage. Read the passage through carefully before making your choices. Each choice in the bank is identified by a letter. Please mark the corresponding letter for each item on the **Answer Sheet** with a single line through the center. You may not use any of the words in the bank more than once.*

The sheets are damp with sweat. You're cold, but your heart is racing as if a killer just chased you down a dark street. It was just a nightmare, you tell yourself; there's nothing to be afraid of. But you are still filled with ____ 71 ____.

Given how unsettling and haunting nightmares can be, is there a way for dreamers to ____ 72 ____, or even turn off, these bad dreams as they happen?

Research is ____ 73 ____, but some studies suggest that people who can master lucid dreaming — that is, the ability to be ____ 74 ____ that a nightmare is happening and possibly even control it without waking up — may hold the ____ 75 ____.

Nightmares are part of the human experience, especially for kids. Doctors ____ 76 ____ don't consider occasional nightmares as a problem. They can just be symptoms of a sleep disorder that can ____ 77 ____ from an unpleasant experience, stress, or certain drugs.

To treat the disorder, there are a number of medicines and therapies that are backed by ____ 78 ____ research, according to the American Academy of Sleep Medicine, which analyzed the available research on the treatment of nightmare disorder in a recent ____ 79 ____ published in the *Journal of Clinical Sleep Medicine*.

However, nightmares are complicated, and researchers are still struggling to understand them, said Dr. Rachel Salas, an expert on sleep disorders and an associate professor at Johns Hopkins Medicine in Baltimore. What we do know is that people ____ 80 ____ to have different kinds of nightmares at different points during the sleep cycle.

[A] amount	[B] answer	[C] avoid
[D] aware	[E] depart	[F] drastically
[G] fear	[H] limited	[I] mechanical
[J] result	[K] review	[L] rigorous
[M] tend	[N] timidity	[O] typically